



THE DISMAL STATE OF SPORTS GAMES

FIFA 29 – comes with *nothing* new

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The entire gaming industry and its relationship with sports games is weird. Game developers like EA have barely any competition in the space, and we keep getting served the same games every year with minimal changes. Why is it so, and what has brought EA to this point of supremacy, where it has become the undisputed God of sports games? Do we need to put down our arms and settle for what we have? The answer is... No. You are the consumer, and they should hear what you say.

Why should they listen?

There are enough precedents set inside the gaming industry. There are many titles that do not get yearly revisions, yet they stand as one of the best-performing financial assets

for their developers. The esports genre is the one with the most examples in this respect. Titles like DOTA 2, League of Legends, and Counter-Strike: Global Offensive attract the same, if not more, players to their servers. Don't believe us? We will let the numbers do the talking. All of the top five games on Steam with the highest number of active players have been out for over three years now, with CS:GO and DOTA 2 closing in on ten years of release. Yet there is no unnecessary sequel of these games coming anytime soon because the developers implement the changes within the existing titles. Which is perfectly fine.

Meanwhile, we keep getting year-on-year iterations of sports games like FIFA and Formula 1, that players have to spend a lot of money on, only to be served the same old

gameplay with a bit of tweaking here and there. We're sure an army of fanboys are headed to our office after reading that sentence, shouting "F1 2021 cars are different from those of 2022!" Well, both games have been built on the same engine. So, an over-the-air update, which would cost some of your internet data balance to download, could bring the same mechanics and car models to your existing titles.

The presence of countless videos on YouTube, with players having the exact same experience with the exact same car models from F1 2022 in the 2021 version of the game is proof enough that an update would do just fine.

The money business

It's always about the money. It is no secret that the FIFA franchise fetch-